



REUTERS/SONAR

ON A ROLL:
Badal (left)
with son, Sukhbir

Rs 1 lakh cr
is the budget for planned
projects in the state

- The state's debt burden is Rs 56,688 crore
- It plans to have four thermal plants by 2011

\$2-3 billion a year. What has also helped is the fresh surge in real estate and VAT collections, which have grown by 44 per cent in six months.

Agriculture remains the state's growth engine, accounting for 40 per cent of the GDP. While the service sector is growing, manufacturing has been stagnant in the absence of fresh investments and because of expensive land, power shortages and tax holiday concessions.

"The tax waiver has been a double-whammy for Punjab," says S.S. Channy, secretary, industries and commerce, referring to the flight of 160 units to neighbouring states. At the same time, there has been a rash of investments in big-ticket infrastructure, retail and housing projects. Projects worth Rs 1 lakh crore as part of Shiromani Akali Dal President Sukhbir Singh Badal's strategy are on a roll. They include the international airport at Mohali, two express highways, three five-star hotels, three dozen flyovers and bridges at the cost of Rs 25,000 crore. There is a plan to make Punjab power surplus by 2011 with four thermal power projects. Also on the anvil is a Rs 3,200-crore project for remodelling its canal system. With such tidings, the state can only look to regain lost glory.

by Ramesh Vinayak

ORISSA IS THE FASTEST MOVER



Realisation of the role of education in economic growth has fuelled higher spending in improving access to education to empower the masses to benefit from emerging opportunities.

KARNATAKA RAJASTHAN WEST BENGAL ASSAM CHHATTISGARH

BIHAR

PRIMARY EDUCATION

VARIABLES: Literacy rate, proportion of 10-plus children having completed primary education, ratio of girls to boys enrolled in schools, teacher-pupil ratio, total expenditure on primary-plus middle school/population.

BIG STATES

RANK			RANK		
2008		2008*	2007	2006	2005
1	HIMACHAL PRADESH	4.26	2	1	1
2	KERALA	3.81	1	2	2
3	UTTARAKHAND	3.27	3	3	3
4	TAMIL NADU	3.11	6	4	4
5	MAHARASHTRA	3.06	4	5	5
6	ASSAM	2.84	5	8	6
7	PUNJAB	2.79	7	6	7
8	JAMMU & KASHMIR	2.75	8	10	8
9	KARNATAKA	2.69	9	7	9
10	ORISSA	2.41	15	14	10
11	ANDHRA PRADESH	2.37	12	9	11
12	GUJARAT	2.33	10	13	12
13	HARYANA	2.25	11	11	13
14	WEST BENGAL	2.18	13	12	14
15	MADHYA PRADESH	1.83	16	16	15
16	RAJASTHAN	1.75	17	17	16
17	CHHATTISGARH	1.75	14	15	17
18	JHARKHAND	1.48	19	19	18
19	UTTAR PRADESH	1.28	18	18	19
20	BIHAR	0.64	20	20	20

SMALL STATES

1	SIKKIM	5.86	3	4	1
2	MIZORAM	5.63	1	2	2
3	GOA	5.57	2	1	3
4	PUDUCHERRY	5.00	4	3	4
5	NAGALAND	4.25	5	6	5
6	MANIPUR	4.16	6	5	6
7	TRIPURA	3.88	9	7	7
8	MEGHALAYA	3.31	8	9	8
9	DELHI	3.07	7	8	9
10	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	2.84	10	10	10

UNION TERRITORIES

1	LAKSHADWEEP	6.49	3	2	1
2	ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS	6.27	2	1	2
3	CHANDIGARH	4.15	1	3	3
4	DAMAN & DIU	3.60	4	5	4
5	DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI	2.69	5	4	5

Rank went down Constant rank Rank went up Fastest Mover